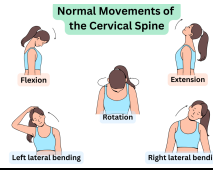
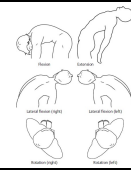


MSK: Spine Physical Exam

Diagnostic Medicine III 2025

STARTING THE PATIENT ENCOUNTER		
Introduction, Verify Patient		
General Survey		
Vital Signs (obtain or repeat abnormal vitals)		
SPINE		
INSPECTION: Cervical Thoracic Lumbar (verbalize)	Posture <i>*Evaluation is best with patient standing however patient mobility should be considered</i>	
	Curvature (viewing the patient from the side)	
	Deformity same as UE	
	Asymmetry	
	Muscle Spasm	
	Swelling same as UE	
	Discoloration	
PALPATION: Cervical Thoracic Lumbar (verbalize)	Paraspinal muscle for tenderness or spasm	
	Spinous Processes for tenderness or step-off	
	Facet joints for tenderness	
	Vertebra for any tenderness or step-offs	
	Sacroiliac joint for tenderness	
ASSESSES: Range of Motion (ROM) → Active	Cervical spine Flexion Extension Rotation (b/l) Lateral bending (b/l)	
	Thoracolumbar Spine Flexion Extension Rotation (b/l) Lateral bending (b/l)	
SPECIAL TESTS		
Spurling test- Ask patient to rotate the head to one side then tilt head back. Repeat on the other side. Positive sign-pain in posterior neck on ipsilateral side. → Cervical radiculopathy		
Straight-leg raise - patient lies supine with neck slightly flexed, leg is raised with knee extended. Performs bilaterally.		Selective lumbar radiculopathy
Leg length measurement - leg length is measured from the anterior iliac spine to the medial malleolus crossing the knee on the medial side. Performs bilaterally. Lumbar Scoliosis, low back pain, SI joint pain, hip osteoarthritis, stress fx,		
Cervical spine strength- Flexion, Extension, Rotation (b/l), Lateral bending (b/l) <i>*Consider for a patient with neck pain</i>		
Scoliosis – have patient stand with knees straight and flex forward at the waist. Inspect for spine curvature, asymmetry of the shoulders, shoulder blades, and hips from anterior and posterior		
Consider whether a neurological examination is necessary when completing a musculoskeletal examination.		

- Flexion: "bring your chin to your chest and hold it there"
 ↳ place your hand on patient's forehead and push backwards
 Extension: "push your head back"
 ↳ place hand on occiput, push forward
 Lateral Flexion: "bring your ear to each shoulder"
 ↳ place hand on side above ear and push towards opposite shoulder
 Rotation: "turn your chin toward your shoulder"
 ↳ place hand on chin/cheek, resist rotation

Order:

- Straight leg Raise
 - Leg length measurement
 - Spurling
 - Cervical Spine strength
 - Scoliosis
- Supine
Sitting